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RESOLVE COMPUTER USER'S PROBLEMS

US 14919

Section A : FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT

QUESTION 1

a) - To ensure accountability - you know who reported the problem and who owns the equipment.

- To get correct contact details for feedback, follow-up questions and to inform them when resolved.

- To determine the user's skill level, role and access rights - this affects how you explain the solution.

- To verify if the user is authorized to request support for that computer/system.

- To maintain an accurate audit trail and incident history for future reference.

b) - Prevents information loss and having to ask the user the same questions again.

- Helps with accurate diagnosis - exact error message, when it happens, what they were doing.

- Allows correct prioritization and assigning to the right technician.

- Provides evidence and documentation for SLA, warranty claims and reporting.

- Enables knowledge base building - if the problem recurs, the solution can be found faster.

- Ensures continuity if the first technician is not available, another can continue.

QUESTION 2 (SO 1, AC 3, AC 4)

a) 1. Active listening - listen without interrupting, take notes, paraphrase problem back.

2. Empathy and reassurance - e.g. "I understand this is preventing you from working, I will help you."

3. Use clear, non-technical language - avoid jargon.

4. Positive attitude and professional tone - be friendly, patient, calm and respectful.

5. Keep the user informed - explain what you are doing and why, give regular updates.

6. Set realistic expectations - don't promise what you can't deliver.

7. Ask open and closed questions to get complete information.

8. Confirm satisfaction - ask "Does that work for you now?"

9. Confidentiality - assure them their data will be kept private.

10. Follow-up - call back after resolution to confirm everything is still working.

b)- Priority helps to handle urgent/critical problems first e.g. server down vs. mouse not working. Ensures business continuity.

- Timeframe sets an SLA and gives the user an expectation of when it will be fixed, reducing anxiety.

- Helps technician to manage workload and plan resources effectively.

- Improves service quality and allows management to measure performance.

QUESTION 3

1. Replicate/Observe - try to recreate the problem to see exact symptoms.

2. Gather information - interview user, check error messages, when it started, what changed.

3. Check the obvious - cables, power, connectivity, caps lock.

4. Use diagnostic tools - Event Viewer, Device Manager, antivirus scan, hardware diagnostics.

5. Isolate the cause - use elimination, test hardware/software in another machine.

6. Research - check knowledge base, internet, manuals, previous tickets.

7. Formulate hypothesis - identify most likely cause.

8. Test hypothesis - apply possible fix in non-destructive way.

9. Document findings - record steps taken and results.

QUESTION 4

- Data backup - ensure user's data is backed up before changes.

- Impact on user and business - downtime, cost, other users affected.

- User skill level - solution user can understand and maintain.

- Security and policy compliance - no violation of IT policy or licensing.

- Least disruptive solution - try simplest fix first.

- Resource availability - software, parts, permissions, time.

- Root cause vs symptom - fix root cause to prevent recurrence.

- Testing - plan to test after implementation and have rollback plan.

QUESTION 5

1. Test solution thoroughly with user to confirm problem is fully resolved.

2. Demonstrate solution and let user test it themselves.

3. User confirmation and sign-off - get verbal or written confirmation.

4. Educate user - briefly explain cause and how to prevent in future.

5. Clean up - remove temporary files, tools, restore workspace.

6. Complete documentation - update ticket with problem, cause, solution, time, parts used.

7. Close ticket in helpdesk system - mark resolved, record closure date/time.

8. Follow-up - contact user after a day or two to ensure problem has not returned.

QUESTION 6

- Do not abandon - inform user honestly that you could not resolve it and why.

- Escalate - escalate to senior technician, specialist or management per procedure with all notes.

- Document everything - record steps tried, findings, reason for escalation.

- Re-assign priority and timeframe - update user on new timeframe and who will handle it.

- Keep user informed - maintain communication until escalated person takes over.

- Log as outstanding/pending - keep ticket open and monitor until final resolution.